

Since that cycle ends soon, and the Mayans didn't bother to pen down more cycles, some people believe they knew something we don't. However, the most plausible explanation is that just as the world doesn't end on December 31st every year, concludes and January 1 begins, so why panic over the ending of an ancient civilisation's weird calendar? But if you really are hung up on the topic, let us give you 9 ways the world could end.

Doomsday Scenario



Alien Invasion

For all we know, the Mayans received an inter-galactic memo, stating that the planet was about to be wiped clean come December 22, 2012. Pretty sure the Mayans are sitting somewhere, with smug smiles on their faces as we get zapped to fairy dust. Heck it's even possible that the civilisation was obliterated by said aliens' last visit whilst in the process of working out the calendar, thus bringing their writing adventures to a halt. Kind of Mass Effect style. Only, less galactic fireworks and more pew-pew.

How to survive

You could build a tin-foil hat to prevent the aliens from hijacking your brain. No but seriously, best way to survive if the Earth is under siege is to, well, you guess it, not to be on Earth! The moon would be a good bet to hide on, but we recommend carefully timing your stay on the rock as it gets insanely hot and cold there. You could also build an underground stronghold, but that's assuming they don't have weapons strong enough to pretty much vaporize the earth (Hitchhiker's Guide to the Galaxy Anyone?) National Geographic has also revealed in a series that many militaries across the globe have plans in place for every scenario when extra-terrestrial makes contact. Everything from initiating friendly contact to contingencies in the event that the invaders are hostile has been accounted for and though the plans are probably more classified than the truth about JFK's assassination, we have been assured that



We come in Peace. Giggity

these plans are solid and that we wouldn't go down without a fight (if at all).

Why it may not happen

Well, first and foremost, we ALL know that Aliens don't exist. Right? Even if they did, we've all seen enough movies to know that they're going to only go after the United States, so we're pretty safe and sound in this part of the world. Cockiness aside, our deep space radios are so fine tuned to the celestial motions that the minute anything seems out of place, all prominent space and military establishments would know it.

Doomsday Scenario



Asteroid or meteor impact

So who reading this remembers the movie Armageddon or Deep Impact? In case

you don't, well, essentially humanity discovers (albeit just in the nick of time) that a giant mass of weird rock is hurtling towards earth at cataclysmic speeds. Impact with the planet would definitely result in the extinction of life. This is a very likely scenario, especially given that it was what most likely caused

the extinction of the dinosaurs. If only the dinosaurs had the technology we have today, they'd still be alive and we'd know what dino-meat tastes like. But here's something to get your stomach in a knot. Statistically, the earth is being bombarded with my meteor fragments almost on an hourly basis. They just burn up in the atmosphere, so we don't see them. However, every 100 years or so comes along an asteroid that can cause mass scale destruction, wiping out all life in a radius of about a couple of thousand kilometre radius. However, every 50-100 million years or so comes along a body of size 10km or larger that would wipe out the entire planet. The Chicxulub crater in the Yucatan Peninsula is the largest known impact crater, probably from the asteroid whose impact was responsible for wiping out the dinosaurs.

How to survive

Surviving an asteroid impact can be anywhere from "pretty simple" to "impossible." Here's why. If the Asteroid is not going to cause a planet-wide rejection of all things living, then an underground



Looks like the universe might want to play target practice with our planet